

Grizzly Bear Survey

Start of Block: Informed Consent

T1 You are being asked to complete this online survey as part of a research study on wildlife management. No prior knowledge is needed, but your careful participation is important for the results to help wildlife management.

This survey is estimated to take about 7 minutes to complete. Participation is completely voluntary. No identifying information will be recorded. Responses will remain completely confidential. There are no known risks associated with participation beyond those of everyday life.

For additional information, contact the research team at the University of Wyoming (tcherry@uwyo.edu), and you may contact the Institutional Review Board at the University of Wyoming (irb@uwyo.edu) if you have questions about your rights as a participant.

By continuing to the survey, you consent to participating. Thank you

End of Block: Informed Consent

Start of Block: Quota Questions

Quota Intro In order for us to ensure proper representation, please answer the following demographic questions. Your answers will be confidential.

state In which state do you currently reside?

▼ Alabama (1) ... I do not reside in the United States (53)

Q27 What is your age?

- ☐ 18 to 19 years (8)
 - ☐ 20 to 24 years (15)
 - ☐ 25 to 34 years (9)
 - ☐ 35 to 44 years (10)
 - ☐ 45 to 54 years (11)
 - ☐ 55 to 59 years (12)
 - ☐ 60 to 64 years (13)
 - ☐ 65 to 74 years (14)
 - ☐ 75 to 84 years (16)
 - ☐ 85 years or more (19)
-

Q29 What is your sex?

- ☐ Male (1)
- ☐ Female (2)
- ☐ No Response (3)

End of Block: Quota Questions

Start of Block: Warm Up Questions

Q1 How important are national parks to you?

- ☐ Very important (1)
 - ☐ Important (2)
 - ☐ Slightly important (3)
 - ☐ Not important at all (4)
-

Q2 How informed are you about wildlife management in the northern rocky mountain region?
(Montana, Wyoming, Idaho)

- ☐ Very informed (1)
 - ☐ Informed (2)
 - ☐ Slightly informed (3)
 - ☐ Not informed at all (4)
-

Q3 In particular, how informed are you about management of grizzly bears in the northern rocky mountain region (Montana, Wyoming, Idaho)?

- ☐ Very informed (1)
- ☐ Informed (2)
- ☐ Slightly informed (3)
- ☐ Not informed at all (4)

End of Block: Warm Up Questions

Start of Block: Background Information

T2 Grizzly Bear Recovery in the Northern Rocky Mountains

Grizzly bears were listed as an endangered species in 1975. Due to management and conservation efforts, their numbers have been recovering well in the northern rocky mountain region (Montana, Wyoming, and Idaho).

The purpose of this survey is to gather public input on the management of grizzly bears in the northern rocky mountain region.

Participation does not require prior knowledge. We will first provide you the necessary background information before asking for your input.

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Q47 The Basics of Grizzly Bear Management

Grizzly bear management identifies how to respond to *problematic* bear encounters. The **management response** depends on the type of **bear encounter**. Generally, there are 3 types of bear encounters and 2 types of management responses. **BEAR ENCOUNTERS** are defined as *property*, *human threat*, or *human injury*, each described as: **Property** - the bear accessed human or livestock food or attacked/killed livestock. **Human Threat** - the bear was aggressive towards people or caused minor injury to a person. **Human Injury** - the bear caused significant injury to a person or killed a person. **MANAGEMENT RESPONSES** separate the bear from the situation by *relocation* or *removal*, each described as:

Relocation - the bear is moved away, typically 40-90 miles away from the encounter location. **Removal** - the bear is euthanized (i.e., killed).

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Q49 Relocation and Removal Thresholds

The *number* and *type* of encounters by a bear determines if that bear is a problem and needs to be relocated or removed.

The relocation threshold is the number of encounters that causes the bear to be relocated. At this and each subsequent encounter, the bear is *relocated* (i.e., moved 40-90 miles away from location).

The removal threshold is the number of encounters that causes the bear to be removed. At this encounter, the bear is *removed* (i.e., killed).

Keep in mind: Since relocation isn't an option once a bear is removed (i.e., killed), **the removal threshold cannot be less than the relocation threshold.** Because each type of encounter presents different risks, **there are different thresholds for each type of encounter.**

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Q34 The Purpose of this Survey

The focus of this survey is to help identify the appropriate thresholds that trigger relocation and removal.

By setting higher or lower thresholds, grizzly bears have more or less freedom of movement.

Female grizzly bears are important for reproduction, so they provide a useful benchmark for setting thresholds. Thus, *all questions are concerned with female grizzly bears.*

In the next two sections, we will ask: what you think are the actual thresholds in current policy, and what you think should be the thresholds in your ideal policy.

End of Block: Background Information

Start of Block: Management Questions

Q30 Your Beliefs About Current Policy

In this section, we will ask for your best guess of the **actual** thresholds used in current grizzly bear management policy.

Q54 For each type of encounter, give your best guess of the *current policy's removal threshold*. In other words, what do you think is the current number of **encounters** that causes a bear to be **removed**?

	1 (1)	2 (2)	3 (3)	4 (4)	5+ (5)
Property Encounter (1)	0	0	0	0	0
Human Threat Encounter (2)	0	0	0	0	0
Human Injury Encounter (3)	0	0	0	0	0

Page Break

Q29 Your Preferences for an Ideal Policy

In this section, we will ask for your preferred thresholds that should be used in an ideal grizzly bear management policy.

Q28 For each type of encounter, give your *preferred removal threshold (if any) in an ideal policy*. In other words, what do you think *should be* the number of **encounters** that causes a bear to be **removed**?

	1 (1)	2 (2)	3 (3)	4 (4)	5+ (5)	Unlimited (never remove) (7)
Property Encounter (1)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Human Threat Encounter (2)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Human Injury Encounter (3)	0	0	0	0	0	0

Page Break

Q36 Grizzly bears are currently listed as an endangered species. If grizzly bears recovered enough to no longer be listed as endangered, generally do you think grizzly bear management should increase or decrease the thresholds that trigger a response?

- ☐ Increase (more lenient) thresholds (1)
- ☐ Decrease (more strict) thresholds (2)
- ☐ Do not change thresholds (3)

End of Block: Management Questions

Start of Block: Personal Information

Q18 Finally, we would like to ask some questions about you. Your answers to these questions are extremely important to make sure that our analysis is reliable and that results can better inform policy. Again, your answers will remain strictly confidential.

Q20 In the past five years, how many times have you visited one or more national parks?

- ☐ More than 15 times (1)
- ☐ 11 to 15 times (2)
- ☐ 6 to 10 times (3)
- ☐ 1 to 5 times (4)
- ☐ No visits in past five years (5)

Q32

Please select 'agree' to show that you are paying attention to the survey.

- ☐ Strongly agree (1)
- ☐ Agree (2)
- ☐ Neither agree or disagree (3)
- ☐ Disagree (4)
- ☐ Strongly disagree (5)

Skip To: End of Block If Please select 'agree' to show that you are paying attention to the survey. != Agree

Q21 In the past five years, how many times have you visited a national park in the northern rocky mountain region? This includes: Glacier National Park (Montana), Yellowstone National Park (Wyoming/Montana/Idaho), and Grand Teton National Park (Wyoming)

- ☐ More than 15 times (1)
 - ☐ 11 to 15 times (2)
 - ☐ 6 to 10 times (3)
 - ☐ 1 to 5 times (4)
 - ☐ No visits in past five years (5)
-

Q22 What is your experience with grizzly bears? (select all that apply)

- ☐ ☒ No experience (6)
 - ☐ Observed bear from a safe distance (7)
 - ☐ Encountered bear from unsafe distance (8)
 - ☐ Property damage by bear (9)
 - ☐ Physical harm by bear (10)
-

Q23 Have you ever lived within 100 miles of area currently inhabited by grizzly bears? If so, how long have you lived in this area? See map: The blue area illustrates the area currently inhabited by bears.

- ☐ No, I do not and have not ever lived in this area. (1)
 - ☐ Yes, 1-2 years (2)
 - ☐ Yes, 3-4 years (3)
 - ☐ Yes, 5+ years (4)
-

Page Break

Display This Question:

If Have you ever lived within 100 miles of area currently inhabited by grizzly bears? If so, how long... = Yes, 1-2 years

Or Have you ever lived within 100 miles of area currently inhabited by grizzly bears? If so, how long... = Yes, 3-4 years

Or Have you ever lived within 100 miles of area currently inhabited by grizzly bears? If so, how long... = Yes, 5+ years

Q25 How much do you agree or disagree with the following statement: grizzly bears are frequently a nuisance and interrupt my personal normal routine?

- ☐ Strongly disagree (17)
 - ☐ Disagree (18)
 - ☐ Neither agree nor disagree (19)
 - ☐ Agree (20)
 - ☐ Strongly agree (21)
-

Display This Question:

If Have you ever lived within 100 miles of area currently inhabited by grizzly bears? If so, how long... = Yes, 1-2 years

Or Have you ever lived within 100 miles of area currently inhabited by grizzly bears? If so, how long... = Yes, 3-4 years

Or Have you ever lived within 100 miles of area currently inhabited by grizzly bears? If so, how long... = Yes, 5+ years

Q24 Have you or anyone in your extended family owned/worked on a farm or ranch that is/was directly affected by grizzly bears?

- ☐ Yes (1)
 - ☐ No (2)
-

Display This Question:

If Have you ever lived within 100 miles of area currently inhabited by grizzly bears? If so, how long... = Yes, 1-2 years

Or Have you ever lived within 100 miles of area currently inhabited by grizzly bears? If so, how long... = Yes, 5+ years

Or Have you ever lived within 100 miles of area currently inhabited by grizzly bears? If so, how long... = Yes, 3-4 years

Q26 What actions have you taken to reduce grizzly bear problems? [select all that apply]

- ☐ Neighbor Network (Phone-tree, group text, or email list that gives updates from authorities) (1)
 - ☐ Livestock Carcass Management (Removal of carcasses) (2)
 - ☐ Electric Fence (3)
 - ☐ Preventing access to crops, grain, and/or livestock foods (4)
 - ☐ Use of bear-proof trash cans (5)
 - ☐ Herding and husbandry practices (6)
 - ☐ Frightening and scare devices (sirens, strobe lights, motion sprinkler systems, etc) (7)
 - ☐ Verified Compensation Programs (8)
 - ☐ Carrying of bear spray when outdoors (10)
 - ☐ Carrying a bear gun (11)
 - ☒ I've taken none of these actions (9)
-

Display This Question:

If What actions have you taken to reduce grizzly bear problems? [select all that apply] != I've taken none of these actions

And What actions have you taken to reduce grizzly bear problems? [select all that apply] , I've taken none of these actions Is Displayed

Q36 Of the actions you've taken, which have been effective at preventing grizzly bear problems? [select all that apply]

- ☐ Neighbor Network (Phone-tree, group text, or email list that gives updates from authorities) (1)
- ☐ Livestock Carcass Management (Removal of carcasses) (2)
- ☐ Electric Fence (3)
- ☐ Preventing access to crops, grain, and/or livestock foods (4)
- ☐ Use of bear-proof trash cans (5)
- ☐ Herding and husbandry practices (6)
- ☐ Frightening and scare devices (sirens, strobe lights, motion sprinkler systems, etc) (7)
- ☐ Verified Compensation Programs (8)
- ☐ Carrying of bear spray when outdoors (10)
- ☐ Carrying a bear gun (11)
- ☒ No actions taken have been effective (9)

Page Break

Q30 What is the highest level of school/degree you have completed?

- ☐ Less than high school (9)
 - ☐ High school graduate (10)
 - ☐ Some college (11)
 - ☐ Associate degree (12)
 - ☐ Bachelor degree (13)
 - ☐ Graduate Degree (14)
-

Q31 In general, how would you describe your views on most political issues?

- ☐ Very conservative (1)
 - ☐ Conservative (2)
 - ☐ Moderate (3)
 - ☐ Liberal (4)
 - ☐ Very liberal (5)
-



Q33 What is your zip code?

Q34 As close as you can recall, what is your household's total annual income before taxes?

- ☐ Under \$15,000 (1)
- ☐ Between \$15,000 and \$24,999 (4)
- ☐ Between \$25,000 and \$34,999 (5)
- ☐ Between \$35,000 and \$49,999 (6)
- ☐ Between \$50,000 and \$64,999 (7)
- ☐ Between \$65,000 and \$74,999 (2)
- ☐ Between \$75,000 and \$99,999 (33)
- ☐ Between \$100,000 and \$149,999 (8)
- ☐ Between \$150,000 and \$199,999 (31)
- ☐ \$200,000 or more (32)

End of Block: Personal Information
